

Teacher Guide — primary / module-01- what-is-iks

IKS Curriculum

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Overview

Module 1 — Five Gifts from India (What is IKS?)

Age band: Primary · **Grades:** 3–5 · **Duration:** 10 sessions × 30 min

What children will learn

Five “gifts” — Indian contributions to the world that they use or hear about every day:

1. **Zero** — the powerful number that makes counting big numbers possible.
2. **Yoga** — moving and breathing together.
3. **Ayurveda** — the old Indian way of staying healthy.
4. **Vedic Math** — fast counting tricks.
5. **Indian classical music** — special sounds called *rāga*.

By Day 10 they can name all 5 gifts and tell a 30-second story about one.

How this module sounds

- One story per day.
- A daily chant of the five gifts.
- Drawing + show-and-tell, not paper quizzes.

Materials

- Drawing paper, crayons
- 5 picture cards (one per “gift”)
- Stickers

Day-by-day

Day	Title	Activity
1	Five Gifts Story	Meet all 5 + chant
2	The Magic Zero	Draw big numbers with

Day	Title	Activity
		and without zero
3	Yoga Gift	One pose, one breath
4	Ayurveda — Three Friends	Three doshas as friends
5	Five-Gift Song	Sing and recall
6	The Math Story	Indian math through a story
7	Sky Watchers	Indian astronomy — Aryabhata story
8	Project Day 1	Pick + draw
9	Project Day 2	Finish + practise
10	Show & Tell	Each child shares for 30 sec

Source

Adapted from Anaadi Foundation's IKS Sessions program; this primary version is original to the curriculum.

10-Day Lesson Plan

Module 1 (Primary) — 10-Day Lesson Plan

Day	Title	Activity
1	Five Gifts Story	Story + meet 5 picture cards
2	Magic Zero	Count to a million game
3	Yoga Gift	Tāḍāsana + bumblebee breath
4	Ayurveda Three Friends	Vāta-Pitta-Kapha picture intro
5	Five-Gift Song	Memorise via singing
6	Math Story	Bakhshali manuscript tale
7	Sky Watchers	Aryabhata story
8	Project Day 1	Pick a gift, start drawing
9	Project Day 2	Finish + practise
10	Show & Tell	30-sec each, sticker for all

Daily structure (30 min)

Time	What
3 min	Settle + the daily chant
10 min	Story/new content
12 min	Drawing/hands-on
5 min	Sharing

Daily chant

“Zero! Yoga! Ayurveda! Vedic Math! Music!”

“Five gifts from India to the whole wide world!”

What children leave with

- Five gifts named confidently
- A drawing of their favourite gift
- A 30-second story to share with a younger sibling

Teacher Notes

Teacher Notes — Module 1 (Primary)

Tone

Story first. Drawing always. No paper tests.

What to celebrate

If by Day 10 every child can: - Name 3 of the 5 gifts - Point to one example in their own life

...the module is a success. Everything else is bonus.

Common things to handle

1. **“Where is football?”** It came from England. Some gifts come from India, some from elsewhere. That’s fine.
2. **“My grandma uses Ayurveda.”** Celebrate! Invite the child to share a family example.
3. **“Why is zero a gift? We learn it in school.”** Yes — and Indians invented the way of using it. Without that invention, school math would look very different.

Safety

- No real fire, no real surgery (we don’t get into Suśruta at this age!), no breath holding.

If you only have 6 days

- Day 1: Five Gifts story
- Day 2: Zero + Yoga (combined)
- Day 3: Ayurveda + Music
- Day 4: Math + Astronomy stories
- Day 5: Project day
- Day 6: Show & Tell

Sources

Sources — Module 1 (Primary)

Teacher reference only.

Source for the five gifts

- All five are well-documented Indian intellectual contributions. For teacher background, see the Middle-band Module 1 `sources.md` for full citations (Plofker, Wujastyk, Pollock, etc.).

Story sources

The “Five Gifts” framing is original to this curriculum. Each gift story draws on real history but is simplified for Primary band.

For families who ask

Point them at the Middle-band module for adult-level depth on each gift.

Day 1 — Five Gifts Story

Module: Five Gifts from India (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children meet all 5 gifts and learn the daily chant.

Materials

- 5 picture cards (zero, yoga pose, herbs/spices, math symbols, vīṇā or other Indian instrument)
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant intro (5 min)

Sit on mat. Teach the chant:

“Zero! Yoga! Ayurveda! Vedic Math! Music!”

“Five gifts from India to the whole wide world!”

Say it 3 times.

Story (10 min)

“A long, long time ago — about 2000 years ago — thinkers in India invented some amazing things. They shared these with the whole world. Today we meet FIVE of them.”

Hold up each card: - **Card 1: the number 0.** “Imagine trying to write ‘one hundred’ without zero. You couldn’t. India gave us zero.” - **Card 2: yoga pose.** “Standing tall like a mountain — that’s a yoga pose called *tāḍāsana*. India invented yoga.” - **Card 3: spices / a tulsi plant.** “Ayurveda is the old Indian way of staying healthy. Things like ginger tea when you have a cold come from this tradition.” - **Card 4: math symbols.** “India invented fast ways to do math in your head. We’ll meet some this week.” - **Card 5: an Indian instrument.** “Indian music has a special structure called *rāga* — different notes for different times of day.”

Drawing (12 min)

Each child picks ONE gift and draws it.

Show + chant (3 min)

2 children show drawings. Class chants the gift name.

Homework

- Tell a parent about one of the five gifts at dinner tonight.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Draw all 5 gifts on one page.
- **Tier down:** Pick the gift with the easiest image (zero or yoga pose).

Day 2 — The Magic Zero

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children see why zero is “magic” — how it changes the value of every digit next to it.

Materials

- Whiteboard
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (5 min)

“Long ago, people had counting systems but no number called zero. The Romans wrote one hundred like this: C. They wrote ten like this: X. There was no symbol for ‘nothing in this place.’”

“In India, mathematicians invented a special idea: ‘nothing’ is ALSO a number, and we write it as ZERO.”

“Watch what zero does:”

Activity — what zero does (15 min)

On the board: - Start with the digit **1**. - Add a zero after it: **10** (now it’s ten). - Add another zero: **100** (one hundred). - Another: **1000** (one thousand). - Another: **10,000** (ten thousand). - One more: **100,000** (one lakh). - Continue to one million.

“Without zero, we couldn’t count these big numbers easily. Zero MAKES ten and hundred and thousand possible.”

Game: Each child writes the biggest number they can think of using zero. Cheers for whoever writes the biggest!

Show + chant (5 min)

- 2 children share their big numbers.
- Daily chant.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- *“Zero is also the answer when you have NOTHING. 5 cookies — eat 5 — you have ZERO left.”*

Homework

- Find ONE thing at home that has zeros in its number (a phone, a price, an address). Bring tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Count to a million in steps of 100,000.
- **Tier down:** Count zeros in 10, 100, 1000.

Day 3 — Yoga Gift

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children try ONE yoga pose with breath co-ordination.

Materials

- Floor space (no shoes)

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (5 min)

“Yoga is a very old practice from India. Yoga means ‘joining’ — joining your body, your breath, and your mind.”

“Today we try ONE pose: tādāsana — mountain pose.”

Practice (15 min)

- Stand tall. Feet firm on floor.
- *“Pretend a string is gently pulling the top of your head up.”*
- *“Take 3 slow breaths.”*
- Hold for 30 seconds. Release. Repeat 3 times.

Then introduce **bumblebee breath**: - Sit cross-legged. Take a slow breath in. - Breathe out humming — “mmmmmmmm” — like a bumblebee. - Do 5 times.

Show + chant (5 min)

- *“How did your body feel after the mountain?”*
- *“How did your head feel after the bumblebee?”*
- Daily chant.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- *“When you feel angry or sad — try mountain pose for 30 seconds. Or 3 bumblebee breaths. Yoga is a TOOL you can carry with you.”*

Homework

- Stand like a mountain for 30 seconds before brushing your teeth tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add tree pose (vrkṣāsana).
- **Tier down:** Just do mountain pose, no breath.

Teacher notes

- Module 8 is the FULL yoga module. Today is just a taste.

Day 4 — Ayurveda: Three Friends

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children meet the three doshas (vāta, pitta, kapha) as “three friends in your body.”

Materials

- 3 picture cards: wind blowing leaves (Vāta), fire/sun (Pitta), water/clouds (Kapha)
- Drawing paper

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Story (10 min)

“Ayurveda is the OLD Indian way of staying healthy. It started about 2000 years ago.”

“Ayurveda says everyone’s body has THREE FRIENDS inside it. We all have all three — but everyone has a special favourite.”

Show the cards:

Vāta (wind friend): - Moves things around inside you. - People with lots of Vāta are quick, talkative, sometimes fidgety.

Pitta (fire friend): - Makes your food into energy. - People with lots of Pitta are sharp, focused, can be a bit fiery.

Kapha (water/earth friend): - Keeps you strong and steady. - People with lots of Kapha are calm, patient, sometimes slow.

“None of these is ‘good’ or ‘bad’ — they’re all friends. The trick is keeping them in balance.”

Drawing (12 min)

Each child draws their three friends. They can give them faces, names, anything!

Show + chant (3 min)

- 2 shares.
- Chant.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- *“Tomorrow we sing about all 5 gifts together!”*

Homework

- Ask a parent: which of the three friends do they think is YOUR favourite?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Make up a story about the three friends having a small argument and making up.
- **Tier down:** Draw just one friend.

Teacher notes

- Module 3 (Ayurveda + Good Health) is the FULL Ayurveda module. Today is a taste.
- Don’t push children to identify their “type” — at this age it’s just an introduction.

Day 5 — Five-Gift Song

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children memorise all 5 gifts via a song.

Materials

- 5 picture cards (one per gift)

Flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Song (10 min)

Use a familiar tune (Twinkle Twinkle or similar):

Zero, yoga, ayurveda, Vedic math and music too, Five great gifts from old, old India,
Things we use, me and you!

Sing 3 times. Add claps on each gift name.

Recall game (12 min)

- Hold up cards one at a time. Class shouts the name.
- Turn cards face-down. Shout from memory.
- Mix the order.

Drawing (3 min)

Quick: each child writes the 5 names on one paper.

Show + chant (2 min)

- Sing one more time, biggest yet.

Homework

- Teach the song to a family member.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Make up a verse 2 of the song.
- **Tier down:** Just sing along — don't worry about every word.

Day 6 — The Math Story

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children hear a story about Indian mathematicians and try one fast trick.

Materials

- Whiteboard

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Story (10 min)

“In old India, there were mathematicians who could do amazing tricks with numbers in their HEAD. No paper. No calculator. Just their mind.”

“One of them was a man named Bhāskara who lived about 900 years ago. He wrote a math book — but he wrote it for his DAUGHTER! Her name was Līlāvātī. He filled the book with little puzzles and stories.”

“Here’s one of Bhāskara’s puzzles in modern words:”

A flock of 24 swans flew over a lake. 12 dived in to swim, 6 flew east, and the rest flew to the west. How many flew west?

(Answer: $24 - 12 - 6 = 6$)

Try a fast trick (12 min)

Teach: **Multiplying by 11.**

Take any 2-digit number: **23**. - Split: 2 _ 3 - Add the digits: $2+3 = 5$ - Put the sum in the middle: **253** - So $23 \times 11 = 253$!

Try together: 41×11 ? 52×11 ? 63×11 ?

(For carries — $78 \times 11 = 7(7+8)8 = 7(15)8 = 858$ — slightly trickier, skip if too hard.)

Show + chant (3 min)

Homework

- Try 5 multiplication by 11 problems with a parent.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Try the trick with carries ($78 \times 11 = 858$).
- **Tier down:** Just remember: “multiplying by 11 has a quick trick.”

Teacher notes

- Module 5 is the full Vedic Math module (the dot method). Today is a different trick to keep things fresh.

Day 7 — Sky Watchers (Indian Astronomy)

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children hear the Aryabhata story and try the “spinning earth” demo.

Materials

- A ball (any size) with a small mark on it
- Open space

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Story (10 min)

“About 1500 years ago, a young man in India named Aryabhata had a BIG idea.”

“In his time, everyone thought the stars went round and round the earth — that’s why the sun rises and sets, why stars move.”

“Aryabhata thought: ‘What if the stars stand still — and WE spin?’”

“He was right! He was 1000 years before anyone in Europe figured this out.”

“He wrote a book called the Aryabhaṭīya. He was only 23 years old.”

Demo (10 min)

- Hold the ball. Put a sticker or mark on it.
- Slowly spin the ball.
- *“If you were standing on this little mark, what would you see? You’d see the room going round and round. But it’s not. YOU are spinning.”*
- Stand the children up. Slowly spin in place 3 times. *“Look around. Did the room move, or did you?”*

Drawing (3 min)

Quick: draw the earth as a ball, with you standing on it.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Tonight, look up at the stars. Notice that the stars seem to move. They don’t. WE’RE moving.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Why don’t we feel the earth spinning? (Because we’re moving WITH it.)
- **Tier down:** Just remember: Aryabhata said WE spin, not the sky.

Day 8 — Project Day 1

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each child picks ONE gift and starts a project.

Materials

- Drawing paper, crayons, recycled materials, clay

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Project choice (5 min)

Each child picks ONE gift + format: - A poster - A 3D model (clay or recycled) - A 30-second story

Project work (17 min)

Quiet work. Teacher rotates: 60 sec per child, ONE question: *“What’s your favourite part?”*

Show + chant (3 min)

Homework

- Finish at home if not done in class. Practise telling about it 2 times.

Day 9 — Project Day 2 (Finish + Practise)

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Finish (15 min)

Children complete their project.

Practise show & tell (8 min)

Each child rehearses their 30-second show-and-tell with a partner.

Show + chant (2 min)

Homework

- Bring everything tomorrow. Practise telling about it once more at home.

Day 10 — Show & Tell

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min (extend if needed)

Goal

Each child shares their gift project for 30 seconds. Sticker for all.

Materials

- Children's projects
- Stickers
- Chime for timing

Flow

Settle + chant + song (5 min)

Biggest chant yet!

Show & Tell (22 min)

- 1 child at a time. 30 seconds. Chime.
- Each child:
 1. Names their gift.
 2. Shows project.
 3. One sentence: why they picked it.

Class claps. Sticker.

Closing (3 min)

- Stand in a circle.
- Sing the song one final time.
- *“You all know the five gifts. They’re with you for life.”*

Homework

- None. Module done.

Oral Recall — Module 1 (Primary)

No paper quizzes. Use these oral checks.

Day 5 song check

Class chorus: name all 5 gifts in order.

Day 7 ball-spin

“What did Aryabhata think spins — the sky or the earth?” (Earth.)

Day 10 = automatic sticker

Every child who participates in show-and-tell gets a sticker.

Activity 01 — Five Gifts Memory Cards

Module: Five Gifts (Primary) · **Day:** 1 / reusable · **Time:** 10 min

Goal

Children match each gift name to its picture.

Materials per pair

- 10 cards: 5 with gift names (Zero, Yoga, Ayurveda, Vedic Math, Music), 5 with simple pictures

Rules

Memory match — face-down grid, flip 2 cards at a time, keep pairs.

Discussion

- Which gift did you remember easiest? Why?

Project Brief

Project — Module 1 (Primary): Five Gifts

What you'll make

Pick ONE of the 5 gifts (Zero, Yoga, Ayurveda, Vedic Math, Music). Make: - A poster, OR - A 3D model (clay or recycled junk), OR - A 30-second story.

Schedule

- Day 7: pick your gift.
- Day 8: start.
- Day 9: finish + practise.
- Day 10: Show & Tell, 30 seconds each.

Stars

	What we celebrate
★	You named your gift
★★	You showed it clearly
★★★	You told us WHY you picked it

All children get a sticker.